

June  
**26**



**1948**

## Berlin airlift

The Allies made the first airdrop of essential supplies into West Berlin, Germany. All other routes to this part of the city had been blocked by Soviet troops in an effort to squeeze out Allied forces.

## Born this day

**1911 Babe Didrikson Zaharias**, US athlete. She won gold medals for hurdling and javelin at the 1932 Olympics, and also excelled at golf, baseball, and basketball.

**1993 Ariana Grande**, US singer and actor. After rising to fame in the hit TV series *Victorious*, she became a chart-topping musical sensation known for her powerful voice.

## The spell is cast

The world's most famous boy wizard was introduced to British readers when *Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone* – the first book in J K Rowling's *Harry Potter* series – was published in the UK.

**1997**

## First barcode

**1974**

Sharon Buchanan, a cashier at the Marsh Supermarket in Troy, Ohio, USA, scanned the first item to be sold using a barcode – a pack of chewing gum.

## Also on this day

**1498** The bristle toothbrush was invented in China, made out of a bamboo stick and wild pig's hair.

**1794** At the Battle of Fleurus, French forces used a hot-air balloon to spy on the enemy – the first-ever military use of an aircraft.

**1976**

## Tall tower

In Toronto, Canada, the 553 m (1,815 ft) CN Tower opened its doors to the public for the first time. It was the world's tallest freestanding structure until 2007.

